

YORK RITE
Mentor and Advanced Studies Program
Commandery Orders
Order of the Red Cross

Name: _____
Phone #: _____ **E-mail:** _____
Chapter, Council or Commandery: _____
Mentors: _____

This exercise is not a test of your memory. It is an exercise to help you seek out more Light and to improve your skills, knowledge and understanding of hidden mysteries within the degrees and orders of York Rite Masonry.

Answers to nearly all of the questions can be found in the quest books and the manual/ritual book. Other answers can be found on the web or within other Masonic and York Rite resources. You should also use your mentor, Brothers and Companions to find or develop your answers.

Note: If you do not agree with a “Provided Answer” feel free to provide your own answer along with evidence and source information supporting your answer.

ORDER OF THE RED CROSS

1. The Illustrious Order of the Red Cross is among the oldest degrees in Masonry, most scholars agree that it was first conferred in the American Colonies in the:
 - a. Later part of the 17th century
 - b. Early part of the 18th century
 - c. Later part of the 18th century
 - d. Early part of the 19th century
 - e. Later part of the 19th century
2. Those same scholars believe that it was brought to the Colonies by _____ or _____ troops, but others believe it was brought by _____ following his travels in Europe.
3. What two early Masons are seen as the driving force behind the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross and responsible for its adoption into our system? _____
4. What is the battery of knocks for the Order of the Red Cross?
 - a. Six
 - b. Seven
 - c. Eight
 - d. Nine
5. The battery of knocks allude to several things, name one of them: _____

YORK RITE
Mentor and Advanced Studies Program
Commandery Orders
Order of the Red Cross

6. In the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross the Bible is opened to what chapter?
 - a. Psalms 23
 - b. II Esdras (Ezra)
 - c. Amos 7
 - d. Genesis 2
7. What body does the Jewish Council represent?
 - a. Pharisees
 - b. Sadducees
 - c. Sanhedrin
 - d. Essenes
8. In the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross who does the candidate represent and presents himself as a _____ and _____
9. Who is Zerubbabel and what is his house? _____
10. What was being debated by the Grand Council and why were they worried about Zerubbabel's journey? _____
11. The foundation for the second Temple was laid in what year?
 - a. 651 BC
 - b. 520 BC
 - c. 477 BC
 - d. 398 BC
12. What king ended the Babylonian Captivity? _____
13. How long did the Babylonian Captivity last?
 - a. 50 years
 - b. 75 years
 - c. 100 years
 - d. 250 years
14. The lessons of the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross are represented by the Grand Characteristics of _____, _____ and _____?
15. The Illustrious Order of the Red Cross represents change and transition. What are the changes and the transitions represented?

YORK RITE
Mentor and Advanced Studies Program
Commandery Orders
Order of the Red Cross

16. What is considered the key word of the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross?
- Faith
 - Hope
 - Courage
 - Truth
17. What is the principal lesson of the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross?
- Loyalty is always paramount
 - Truth is unchanging and eternal
 - Nothing but your best work is satisfactory
 - Integrity must never be sacrificed
18. When Zerubbabel crossed the river the Persians guards arrested him and garbed him as a slave. Is this significant and how so? _____
19. Why did King Darius favor the Jews? _____
20. What was King Darius' vow? _____
21. How was Zerubbabel tested? _____
22. Zerubbabel is given a gift by the King. What is the gift and why is it so valuable?

23. The Illustrious Order of the Red Cross is conducted as part of the Commandery of Knights Templar system in both England and the United States. True / False
24. As like several degrees the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross is performed out of sequence. If the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross was performed in its proper sequence it would be after the _____ degree and before the _____ degree.
25. The Illustrious Order of the Red Cross is divided into three acts. What is the setting of each act?
- Act I: _____
 - Act II: _____
 - Act III: _____

YORK RITE
Mentor and Advanced Studies Program
Commandery Orders
Order of the Red Cross

The following are the short answer essay questions. These questions don't have a "correct" or single answers. It all about what it means to you as a man and a Mason. You may write your answer on this page or use an attached sheet.

26. So far you have identified one thing that the battery of knocks in the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross alludes to. Identify several more and explain how they relate to the Order.

27. In the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross the Candidate is presented a green sash (or baldric) with a red cross superimposed upon it. Describe the sash and what the colors and symbols represent and allude to.

28. Some early American Knights Templar want to eliminate the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross from our system of order. Explain controversy surrounding the IORC, at this time, and how it was resolved.

29. When you look at the Jewish and Persian Banners, while crossing over the river by way of a bridge, what does each of these items represent or symbolize and what is their meaning? When you put them together, what is the overall meaning?

YORK RITE
Mentor and Advanced Studies Program
Commandery Orders
Order of the Red Cross

30. The Illustrious Order of the Red Cross is divided into three acts, which is the most important act and why do think so?

31. Identify one thing that you think is a hidden meaning within the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross and why is it important.

32. What is the thing within this order that struck you the most?

33. Did you find this exercise useful and or meaningful and why?

34. What can we do to improve or make this exercise better?